

A carpet of seedlings

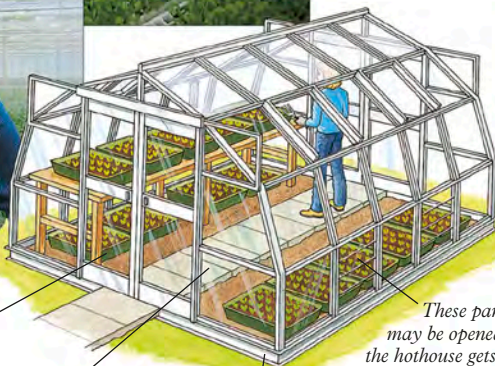
Seeds germinate quickly in the warmth and protection of the hothouse. These are lettuce seedlings. Hothouses can be large and some are half the size of a football field.



Doors must fit neatly to keep out drafts.

The hothouse has transparent sides to let in as much light as possible.

This hothouse only uses natural heat, but some have special heaters.

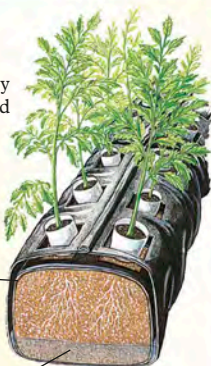


Water gardens

Some vegetables can be grown without soil. The plants are carefully supported and supplied with water which is automatically mixed with plant foods. This way of growing plants is called hydroponics.

This material does not feed the plants, but helps to support them.

Water full of plant food flows past the roots.



Mixed vegetables

Here are some other vegetables that would normally need lots of sun to grow, but can be farmed in hothouses in cool climates.



Cucumbers



French beans



Eggplant



Zucchini



Okra



Red and green chillies

